FREE FAITH GUIDE

The Daughter Who *Stayed*

EVERYTHING HE HAS IS ALREADY YOURS.



LUKE 15

Chaotic Sunshine

The daughter who *stayed.*

Everything for one honest conversation: the lesson, the back story, the questions, memory cards and a coloring page.

1 · LESSON RECAP
2 · BACK STORY
3 · TALK IT THROUGH
4 · MEMORY CARDS
5 · COLORING PAGE

LESSON RECAP

You never left. You can stop invoicing.

The older brother in Luke 15 never ran off. He worked hard, kept the rules and kept the farm running. And when his brother came home to a party, he was furious: "All these years I've been slaving for you" (Luke 15:29). He lived in his father's house with a servant's heart. Resentment is often the tell. The father's answer is stunning: "you are always with me, and everything I have is yours" (Luke 15:31). The inheritance was already his. He never asked, because he thought he had to earn it.

THE LINE THAT CHANGES EVERYTHING

already yours

LUKE 15:31 · THE FATHER TO THE SON WHO STAYED

Nothing to earn, nothing to invoice. "Everything I have is yours." You get to ask, and then you get to share.

	Living like hired help	*Living like a daughter*
WORK	"All these years I've been slaving" (15:29)	"You are always with me" (15:31)
OTHERS	Her blessing feels like my loss	"Rejoice with those who rejoice" (Romans 12:15)
GOD	Keeps score, owes me a goat	"Everything I have is yours" (15:31)

> *"'My son,' the father said, 'you are always with me, and everything I have is yours.'"*
>
> LUKE 15:31 · NIV

TAKE THIS HOME

Everything He has is mine. I can stop invoicing.

PLOT TWIST

The older son asked why he never got "even a young goat" (Luke 15:29). The father's answer covered the whole farm: "everything I have is yours" (15:31).

you never left. come on in.

THE BACK STORY

Meanwhile, at the other end of the party...

STORY ID CARD

Told by: Jesus (Luke 15:11-32)
Told to: Tax collectors, sinners and grumbling religious leaders (15:1-2)
Written by: Luke, a careful researcher (Luke 1:1-4)
Format: the third of three "lost" stories

three stories. one point.

What was going on

Tax collectors and sinners were gathering around Jesus, and the Pharisees and teachers of the law muttered, "This man welcomes sinners and eats with them" (Luke 15:1-2).

So Jesus told three stories: a lost sheep (15:3-7), a lost coin (15:8-10) and a father with two lost sons (15:11-32). The younger son runs. The older son stays home and still ends up outside.

Read Luke 15 like a playlist

15:1-7
The grumbling. The lost sheep.

15:8-10
The lost coin. A party.

15:11-24
The son who ran. A party.

15:25-32
The son who stayed. Will he go in?

Why it matters

The father "went out and pleaded with him" (15:28). Kenneth Bailey, who taught for decades in the Middle East, described the son's refusal as a public insult; the father goes out anyway ("The Pursuing Father," Christianity Today, 1998).

The story ends without telling us if the older brother went in (15:32). Many teachers note Jesus left that ending open for the grumblers listening, and for us.

SO WHAT?

You can be at church every Sunday and still stand outside the party.

the door's open.

IF THIS STIRS UP A LOT

Seasons of feeling unseen are real. Talking with a counselor, pastor or trusted friend is a strong, wise move. If someone is hurting you, getting safe comes first: National Domestic Violence Hotline 1-800-799-7233. In a crisis, call or text 988.

TALK IT THROUGH · ABOUT 45 MINUTES

Pull up a chair.

BRING
A snack, a pen and your honest self.

WHO
3 to 8 friends. "Pass" is always allowed.

TABLE RULE
What's shared here stays here.

SPARK · 5 MIN

What's the best party you've ever been to, and what made it great?

host goes first.

READ IT OUT LOUD · 5 MIN

Read **Luke 15:25-32** together. Listen for every "my," "your" and "this brother of yours."

QUESTIONS · 25 MIN · START LIGHT, GO DEEPER

1. What's something you complained about at the time that you're grateful for now?
2. Where do you see the older brother's reaction in church culture, or in yourself? (Name behaviors, not people.)
3. Resentment is often the tell. When did a friend's good news stir up "What about me?"
4. The father went out to the son who was sulking (15:28). What does that tell you about how God comes after you?
5. **Deep End:** On a scale of 1 to 10, how much do you relate to the older brother right now? What have you been working for that God says is already yours?

SAY IT BACK
"Everything He has is mine. I can stop invoicing." Out loud, every morning this week.

BLESS HER BY NAME
Name one blessing someone else got that stirred envy. Thank God for it, then tell her what you're glad about.

START A JAR
One thank-you on a slip of paper each day. Read them on Thanksgiving.

CLOSE IN PRAYER

Father, You say we are always with You and everything You have is ours. We've served like hired help and kept score like accountants. Thank You for coming out to get us. Teach us to rejoice with our sisters by name, and bring us in to the party. Amen.

KEEP THE JOY COMING

Get the Sunshine Mail.

One Sunday a month: Scripture, an honest reflection, and a little room for surprises.

Share your table on Instagram **@chaoticsunshinetable**.

chaoticsunshine.com

SCAN TO SIGN UP

CUT ON THE DASHED LINES

MEMORY VERSE

"'My son,' the father said, 'you are always with me, and everything I have is yours.'"

LUKE 15:31 · NIV

MIRROR CARD

Everything He has is *mine.*

LUKE 15:31 · NIV

tape me where you get ready.

POCKET REMINDER

I can stop invoicing.

This week: bless one woman by name whose blessing stirred envy in you.

you never left. come on in.

COLOR ME

Already Yours

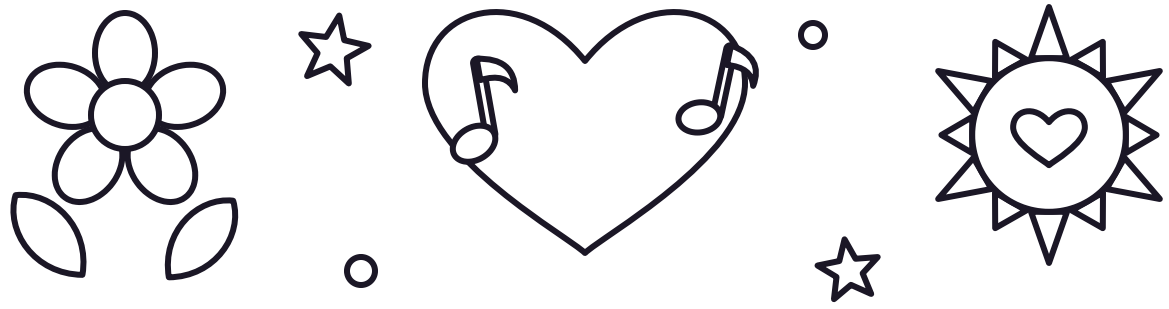
LUKE 15:31 · NIV



Everything He has is mine.

...everything I have is yours.

LUKE 15:31 · NIV



Margin Notes

what I can stop invoicing for:

Sunshine Mail

chaoticsunshine.com

CHAOTIC SUNSHINE